VIET CONG WEAPONS

In the early years of the insurgency the Viet Cong used whatever arms they could lay their hands on, displaying great ingenuity in creating home-made weaponry. Later they received Soviet and Chinese machine-guns, rifles, and grenade launchers along the Ho Chi Minh trail and from contact with the North Vietnamese Army. Their enemies were also a major source of supply, including arms and ammunition traded by South Vietnamese soldiers.

Machete
The Viet Cong were skilled at recycling the debris of modern warfare. Knives like this small multi-purpose machete were often fashioned from steel salvaged from wrecked US vehicles.

Pouch contains two or three ammunition clips of ten rounds

End pouch containing cleaning kit for the SKS

Ammunition belt
This light cloth belt was designed specifically for carrying ammunition for the SKS. With the strap passing round the neck, the belt was fastened at the back and the pouches worn across the stomach.

Integral bayonet that folds back along the barrel

Cleaning rod

SKS AMMUNITION STRIPPER CLIP

Folding bipod for firing from the prone position

RPD CANVAS AMMO POUCH

Hand grenades
The VC used an enormous range of Soviet- and Chinese-made grenades. The Russian anti-tank RKG-3 was especially valued. When the pin is pulled a parachute is released allowing the grenade to float down vertically so that it lands on the top of the tank, its most vulnerable surface.

FOUR-POCKET GRENADE POUCH

Strap for carrying pouch bandolier-style over shoulder

Chinese-made stick grenade

Parachute in handle

RKG-3 ANTI-TANK GRENADE

Safety lever

RUSSIAN RGD-5 GRENADE

Burning gas and smoke from rocket expelled here